

[NT Lesson 16](#): “I Was Blind, Now I See” John 9-10 (See NTL16 [Study Guide](#))

Purpose: To help us have a greater understanding and appreciation of Jesus Christ as the Light of the World and the Good Shepherd.

1. Jesus gives sight to a man who was born blind.

• Read [John 9](#). “And as Jesus passed by, he saw a man which was blind from his birth.” †1. Ted L. Gibbons

• John 9:2-3. “Master, who did sin, this man, or his parents, that he was born blind?” †2. Elder Boyd K. Packer

• John 9:5-7, 35-38. “As long as I am in the world, I am the light of the world.”

In what ways did Jesus bring light to the blind man? To us?

• [John 9:10-11, 15, 17, 24-25, 27, 30-33](#). “The man who had been blind testified ... that Jesus healed him” (*LM*)

What can we learn from this man's example?

How did this man's testimony grow as he continued to share it? (Compare John 10 verses [11, 17, 33, and 38](#).)

How has your testimony grown as you have shared it?

• [John 9:16, 18-20, 24, 28-29, 34](#). “This man is not of God, because he keepeth not the Sabbath day.”

Why do you think the Pharisees denied that Jesus had performed this miracle by the power of God?

How do some people today deny the power of God? †3. President Spencer W. Kimball

• John 9:18-23. “We know this is our son, and that he was born blind ... he shall speak for himself.”

How can we be more valiant in our testimonies?

• John 9:34-38. Pharisees said, “Thou was altogether born in sins, and dost thou teach us? And they cast him out.”

“Being cast out meant being excommunicated.” (*Lesson Manual*) †4. Elder Bruce R. McConkie

• John 9:39-41. “I am come ... that they which see not might see; and that they which see might be made blind.”

The Pharisees “knew the law very well, but they were blind to its true purpose. They refused to see that Jesus came in fulfillment of the law.” (*Lesson Manual*)

What is the difference between seeing with our eyes and “seeing” or understanding spiritually?

What are some causes of spiritual blindness?

What can we learn from this account about how to overcome spiritual blindness? †5. Joseph Smith

2. Jesus teaches that he is the Good Shepherd.

• Read [John 10:1-15, 25-28](#). “But he that entereth in by the door is the shepherd of the sheep.” †6. Sheepfold Door

• John 10:4, 27. “And when he putteth forth his own sheep, he goeth before them”.

What are some qualities of a good shepherd? †7. Good Shepherd Qualities †8. Intimate knowledge of the sheep

• John 10:11-14. “The hireling fleeth, because he is an hireling, and careth not for the sheep.”

• [2 Nephi 9:41-42](#). The “keeper of the gate is the Holy One of Israel ... for he cannot be deceived”.

• John 10:17-18. “No man taketh [my life] from me ... I have power to lay it down, and I have power to take it again.”

How can we hear the Lord's voice? (See [D&C 1:37-38](#); [D&C 18:33-36](#); [D&C 97:1](#).)

How are we protected when we know and follow the voice of the Good Shepherd?

• John 10:1. “He that entereth not by the door into the sheepfold, but climbeth up some other way, the same is a thief”

Who are some of the thieves and robbers who try to enter the sheepfold?

How can we discern between true shepherds and those who try to lead us astray?

• John 10:10. “The thief cometh ... to steal, ... I am come that they might have life, and ... have it more abundantly.”

How can we discern between true shepherds and those who try to lead us “some other way”?

• John 10:9-10, 28. “I am the door: by me if any man enter in, he shall be saved ... and find pasture.”

Next Week: L17 “What Shall I Do That I May Inherit Eternal Life?”; See L17: [Class Member Study Guide](#).

(You can download a free LDS Institute manual at: [New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212](#).) † •

†1. **Nancy Jensen:** “Of all the miracles that Christ performed during his earthly ministry among the Jews, the healing of the man blind from birth is the only one that takes up an entire chapter. There must be a lot we can learn from this singular story and apply to our own lives.” (“[New Testament Lesson #16](#), at LDS Gospel Doctrine Plus, April 17, 2011.)

What are some lessons you see?

†2. **Elder Boyd K. Packer:** “The greatest decision of life is between good and evil.

“We may foolishly bring unhappiness and trouble, even suffering upon ourselves. These are not always to be regarded as penalties imposed by a displeased Creator. They are part of the lessons of life, part of the test.

“Some are tested by poor health, some by a body that is deformed or homely. Others are tested by handsome and healthy bodies; some by the passion of youth; others by the erosions of age.

“Some suffer disappointment in marriage, family problems; others live in poverty and obscurity. Some (perhaps this is the hardest test) find ease and luxury.

“All are part of the test, and there is more equality in this testing than we sometimes suspect.” (“[The Choice](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1980, 21)

†3. **President Spencer W. Kimball:** “When people know right from wrong and find themselves in the broad way to destruction, they have two ways to go. They may repent and cleanse themselves and obtain eventual peace and joy, or they may rationalize and excuse themselves and try the “escape” road. Those who follow the latter road sometimes so completely rationalize that they become calloused and lose the desire to repent, until the Spirit of God ceases to strive with them. Those who choose to meet the issue, and transform their lives, find it the harder road at first but the more desirable one in the end.” (*The Teachings of Spencer W. Kimball*, 82)

†4. **Elder Bruce R. McConkie quotes Alfred Edersheim:** “This was only the beginning of what might be. ‘Still more terrible was the final excommunication, or Cherem [by which is meant being put out of the synagogue], when a ban of indefinite duration was laid on a man. Henceforth he was like one dead. He was not allowed to study with others, no intercourse was to be held with him, he was not even to be shown the road. He might, indeed, buy the necessities of life, but it was forbidden to eat or drink with such an one.

“There were twenty-four grounds for imposing this final type of excommunication, including resisting ‘the authority of the Scribes, or any of their decrees,’ and leading others ‘either away from the commandments, or to what was regarded as profanation of the Divine Name.’ (Edersheim 2:184.) Those who confessed that

Jesus was the Messiah would, of course, be guilty of these violations.” (*The Mortal Messiah*, 3:205)

†5. **Joseph Smith:** “The things of God are of deep import; and ... careful and ponderous and solemn thoughts can only find them out.” (*Teachings of the Prophet Joseph Smith*, 137)

†6. **Sheepfold Door:** “In Jesus’ time, sheep were led to an enclosure called a sheepfold for the night. One of the shepherds would guard the door while the others went home to rest. If wild animal got into the sheepfold, the shepherd would give his life if necessary to protect the sheep. In the morning, each shepherd would return and call his sheep. They would recognize his voice and follow him to pasture.” (*Lesson Manual*)

†7. **Good Shepherd Qualities:**

a. He knows his sheep, calls them by name, and leads them (John 10:3-4, 14).

b. He is the door of the sheep, allowing them to enter the fold to be saved and find pasture (John 10:7, 9).

c. He gives the sheep “life ... more abundantly” (John 10:10).

d. He gives his life for the sheep (John 10:11, 15). (*Lesson Manual*)

†8. **Intimate knowledge of the sheep:** “They are usually counted each evening as they enter the fold, but sometimes the shepherd dispenses with the counting, for he is able to *feel* the absence of any one of his sheep. With one sheep gone, something is felt to be missing from the appearance of the entire flock. One shepherd in the Lebanon district was asked if he always counted his sheep each evening. He replied in the negative, and then was asked how he knew if all his sheep were present. This was his reply: ‘Master, if you were to put a cloth over my eyes, and bring me any sheep and only let me put hands on its face, I could tell in a moment if it was mine or not.’” (Fred H. Wight, *Manners and Customs of Bible Lands*, 159)

Recommended Reading:

1. Elder Boyd K. Packer, “[The Choice](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1980, 21.

2. Elder Lynn A. Mickelsen, “[Light and Growth](#),” *Ensign*, September 2004.

3. Sally Johnson Odekirk, “[Good Shepherds](#),” *New Era*, April 2008.

4. Homer S. Ellsworth, “[Thoughts on the Good Shepherd](#),” *Ensign*, December 1985.

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